

over-limit fees, he paid off the entire balance, \$799.19, by writing a check for \$800, and he closed the account.

Now what he did next is why I really like this guy. He treated them like they treat us. He then wrote the credit card company a letter, requesting a refund of the eighty-one cents he overpaid. “I’d prefer that you send a certified check or money order, since you have no credit history with me and I have no information in regard to your references,” he wrote.

If they did not pay him within 25 days, he told them that they would be subject to the \$105 late fee. He was informed that they would refund his overpayment and \$70 of the over-limit fees he paid. They, however, did not make payment to him in the 25-day timeframe that they allow for their customers to pay their bills, so Mr. Hilsabeck stated he would assess additional late fees and finance charges of 20% for every month that they were delinquent. He maintained that he would continue to send them statements each month even though they said they would not pay. This article ran in October 2005. I do not know if he is still persisting, but I like his gumption. He is only treating them the exact way they treat their customers.

It’s Where You Live

It happens every day, in every city, town, and borough. Men and women; low income and high income; less educated and highly educated; every color, every creed; every “consumer” is at risk for these scams. Albert Einstein is attributed as saying something to the effect that “compound interest is the most powerful force in the universe.” I don’t disagree. I also believe that knowledge is the most powerful force in the universe.

As with all my books, I tell you that knowledge is power, and by reading this book cover to cover, you will be armed with the ammunition that you need to know so that you will never be taken advantage of again by the banks and credit card companies.

Take the time to read this book through, chapter by chapter, in order. I don’t talk in financial jargon or legalese. I speak the plain truth in plain English. You will understand every word, and the techniques